

Businesses have come over the year to swear by presentations, and as a corollary, PowerPoint—and that’s a given; no debates. (Debates belong in the realm of how to make *effective presentations*, which we’ll get to in Chapter 2.)

Now here’s an excerpt from *Moving to multimedia: computer presentations can enhance your business*, by Valencia Roner:

They say image is everything. This is especially true for small businesses that need to differentiate themselves from the competition. Many of these businesses are using multimedia presentations to market their firm’s expertise, products and services in ways that can outshine their rivals.

If prepared properly, multimedia presentations can benefit any small business, says Michael Thomas, executive director and CEO of Executive Suite Consulting in Sunnyvale, California. He suggests that multimedia presentations can create the perception that the small business is larger than it is, or has more resources than it actually does. This kind of “deception” may create opportunities that did not exist before. In other words, perception sells.

In sum, a good presentation can make believers of non-believers; it can be life-changing if you make it sufficiently impressive. A good presentation can make or break relationships, reputations, and rapport. A good presentation can impact, influence and impose.

1.2 Beyond The Boardroom

About businesses, you probably already know. Now for the general idea: a well-crafted presentation can have much more impact than, for example, a good thesis, a good article, a really good blog post. That’s human nature. We like things summarised, visualised for us, and presented in an easily-digestible format.